



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:	HAND AND POWER TOOLS				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Often at times we overlook the hazards associated with the common tools that are used on a daily basis. Below are tips on awareness of the potential hazards of these tools and how to minimize these hazards.

Training:

- Each employee using hand and portable power tools must receive training on how to safely operate the tool

Pre Inspection Use:

- Damaged or cracked housing, power source, or bits/accessories
- Dull blades are often more dangerous than sharp blades
- Missing guards or protective devices
- Leaking petrol, oil or other fluids
- Tool appears to be in poor condition
- Does the tool have a 3 wire cord, if not is it double insulated?
- Ensure area is free of any potential trip hazards
- Do not underestimate the importance of a clean work area
- Should it be 110V?

Proper Use:

- Ensure you are wearing the correct PPE
- Use the proper tool for the job
- Follow the manufacturer's instructions
- If unsure about use, ask a supervisor or coworker for clarification
- Ensure tools are not pointed at or operated in close proximity to other individuals
- Use spark resistant tools when working near a fuel source
- Do not use excessive force to cut/drill through hard materials
- Petrol/Mixed Fuel Powered Tools must be off and cool when re-fueled, use only in well ventilated areas

Storage:

- Drain fluids if equipment will be in storage for an extended period of time
- De-energise tools prior to storage (includes removing air pressure, hydraulic pressure and removing loads)
- Store electric tools in dry areas
- Store flammables in accordance with applicable regulations

**Discussion Points**

Do you know how to use and care for hand and power tools correctly?

Do you know how to report any defects of equipment and to who and where?